

Monthly Report September 2026

Roligt Foods Operations & Technology

Prepared: 26 September 2026

The first half of the month went to the vending business, and from mid-month the plant operations system took over. In between, I supported the BTL activation.

In short

- The vending machines are safer and more reliable now — alerts that fire once for real problems, a security risk closed, and tablets that recover on their own.
- The plant operations system went from nothing to a complete, access-controlled system in eleven days.
- All plant data has moved into Zoho, next to our finance and sales data, at no extra cost.
- Every staff member now gets their own login, with access to each screen granted or removed individually.
- The app opens in seconds on a phone. It used to take over a minute.
- Ordering screens for the first three Nurture kiosks are due on 25 October, and that work has started.

1. The month in numbers

Measure	Result
Plant system build-out	From nothing to a complete, access-controlled system in 11 days
Code protection	100+ files now safe — every change recorded, updates go live on their own
Zoho Tables setup	30 tables holding all our plant data
Access control	26 screens , each one opened or closed per person
Login providers compared	10 , before choosing WorkOS
Automated tests	235 running to keep everything working
Opening the app on a phone	over a minute → seconds
Nurture kiosk launch	First three machines go live on 25 Oct

2. What was delivered

2.1 Vending machines *(first half of the month)*

- The temperature alerts now tell the difference between a real cooling problem and a faulty sensor. An alert goes out once per problem and stops on its own when the machine is back to normal.
- Machine passwords and connection details were removed from the app itself, and machines are now managed from our own server instead of a customer's browser.
- If a machine starts a drink and doesn't finish it, the system catches it, adjusts the customer's order, and keeps a record of why each order ended the way it did. This gives us something to point to when a pour is disputed.
- The kiosk tablets were reset with new security keys and locked down as dedicated devices. The app restarts itself after an update, so a remote refresh no longer leaves a blank screen on a machine.
- The database was cleaned up — leftover clutter that slowed down every save was removed, and old data we no longer need was audited.
- The fleet dashboard now shows when a tablet was actually last seen, so a dead machine no longer looks alive. I also wrote down how inventory handover works, so it isn't locked in one person's head.

We send a technician based on that dashboard, so it has to tell the truth.

2.2 Plant operations system (*mid-month onward*)

- The whole system — procurement, production, quality control, orders, dispatch, inventory and traceability — is now properly protected. Every change is recorded, nothing gets lost, and a fix goes live on its own within minutes. Three long-standing irritations were fixed in the same pass: the traceability search, the audit trail, and how storage areas are managed.
- The whole interface was redesigned to be calmer and easier to use, especially on phones, with one consistent look across all screens. Two new areas were added: the staff roster (shifts and attendance) and the production planning board.
- Opening the app on a phone used to take well over a minute when it had to reload everything. It now opens in seconds — the phone receives only what changed and downloads only what it needs. 235 automated tests make sure the speed fixes didn't break anything.

The floor team uses this every day on phones in a cold room. A tool that takes a minute to open is a tool that gets bypassed.

2.3 Orders and planning

- Orders are now raised drink by drink, with quantities for each pack size, and they can't be saved without a ship-by date. An order without a deadline isn't a plan, it's a wish.
- The planning board now shows the true picture: what packing plans will use up counts as demand, what extraction and blending plans will produce counts as supply, and finished plans drop out of the way. It can be narrowed to this week or next week, and late or undated orders stay visible instead of hiding.

"What do we need to make this week, and are we on track?" is now a screen, not a spreadsheet and a meeting.

2.4 Quality control

- Sensory evaluation was added — proper tasting-panel scoring sheets alongside the lab tests we already track.
- Every packing run now sets aside control samples. We know exactly when each one expires (seven days from packing), and the date is recorded when samples are destroyed. This is a basic food-safety requirement when a customer or FSSAI asks to see our records.
- A tool that could wipe a test run with one click was removed — that was more risk than convenience.

2.5 Moving our data to Zoho

We tested building the plant app inside Zoho Creator and compared it honestly with keeping our own app and using Zoho Tables as the database. Our app's ability to work without internet and its custom screens are exactly what Creator can't provide, and rebuilding there would take months. So we kept our app and moved the data to Zoho.

- A 30-table Zoho Tables setup now holds everything — vendors, items, batches, stock records and dispatches.
- The connection between the app and Zoho was built to stay within Zoho's limits and recover smoothly when Zoho asks us to slow down.

We already pay for Zoho One, so the plant's data now sits next to our finance and sales data at no extra cost, and the whole company can report on it.

2.6 Logins and access

The system holds procurement costs, quality decisions and staff data, so it needed real accounts.

- We first tried Kinde, but its free plan allows only two roles and ten permissions — not enough for a plant.
- Ten login providers were compared on three requirements: unlimited roles, permissions we can define ourselves, and managing users from inside our own screens rather than someone else's website. WorkOS was chosen.
- Every staff member now gets a company account. Access is given screen by screen — twenty-six screens, each opened or closed per person, the admin screens included. Users and roles are managed from our own Settings page, every sensitive action is recorded with a name against it, and the system can never lock out its last admin. Remove someone, and their very next tap is refused.

2.7 BTL activation

- I built the product information pages for all four drinks — nutrition details, batch dates and FSSAI information — and the Zoho Forms used to collect responses for the activity.

3. What's next

Priority	What's involved	Deadline
Finish the move to Zoho	Check that two people saving at the same moment never causes a double-count and that the app works on a weak	—

Priority	What's involved	Deadline
	signal, then switch daily use over	
Turn on logins for the whole team	Set up the extra security step, then switch it on for everyone	With the Zoho switch
Build the Nurture kiosk ordering screens	Three machines go live on a fixed date and need to take orders from day one	25 Oct
Make the system match the plant	Blending and repacking draw from finished packed stock instead of bulk	—
Fix the merge gap	Close the one case where simultaneous edits could overwrite each other	—

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